

Bet You Didn't Know

Your Own Search Keywords in Internet Explorer

Opera and Firefox let you use keywords to search from the address bar. You can implement this in Internet Explorer too via a registry tweak. If that frightens you, use the Tweak UI utility, which can be downloaded from Microsoft's Web site.

Visit the search engine site you want to add a keyword for, search for something, say a phrase, and copy the URL. Next, expand Internet Explorer in the left pane of Tweak UI and then click Search. In the right pane, click Create and paste in the URL. Now, replace the phrase you searched for with %, and enter a keyword of your choice in the Prefix box. For example, if you want to add Google, your search string will be something like <http://www.google.co.in/search?q=%s> and the keyword may be g. Click OK twice to change your settings. The next time you want to google Digit, just type in 'g Digit' in the address bar.

automatically delete the history of visited Web sites. Go to **Tools > Internet Options**. On the first tab, under 'History', set the number of days for which the browser should retain the history. If you enter five, then all track of Web sites



Add your keywords for easy, customised searches

older than five days gets purged automatically.

Opera

Multiple Sessions

You can start surfing with the same set of Web sites by saving them as a session.

For example, if you like to start out with a Web-based e-mail site along with a couple of news sites, open them and click on **File > Sessions > Save session**. Save the file with a .win extension in the default location.

You can recall these saved sessions even while browsing some other sites; **File > Sessions > Insert Session** will take care of this. Next, press [Alt] + [P] to bring the



You can choose to start any saved session or last auto-saved session when you start Opera

Preferences dialog, head to **File > Preferences > Start and Exit**. Here, check 'Show start-up dialog' to bring up the startup dialog box every time you open Opera.

This box allows you to maintain multiple sessions and eliminates the frustration associated with a browser crash—you can start browsing at exactly the point where the crash occurred, a very useful feature. The default path for the saved sessions is:

Windows 2000/XP: C:\Documents and Settings\<login name>\Application

Data\Opera\Opera7\profile\sessions\opera.win

Windows 95/98: C:\Windows\ApplicationData\Opera\Opera7\sessions\opera.win

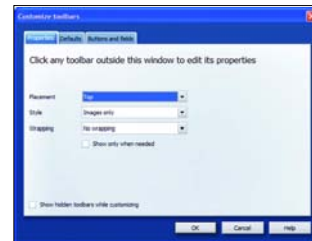
Tabbed Browsing

To use Opera's tabbed browsing feature, enable the Page bar by going to **View > Toolbars > Page bar**. Call a new tab either by pressing [Ctrl] + [N] or double-clicking on an empty Page Bar area. Right-clicking a link and selecting 'Open in background page' opens a tab in the background—a better feature, as it lets you browse the parent page as the link opens without disturbing you. Note that the text of the tab changes colour once it finishes loading a Web page. Browse between tabs by using [Ctrl] + [Tab]. You can also use the mouse to do this: With the mouse right-clicked, use the scroll button to move up and down the list of tabs. Use [Ctrl]+[W] to close any active tab. Close all open tabs using [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [W]. To close all tabs, but the one you are browsing under, press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [W]. You can also change the position of the tabs by simply dragging and dropping them wherever you deem them to be fit.

Clothes Make the Browser

The default user interface can be tweaked to be leaner and much less of a resource-hogger. Right-click on the Main Bar, click on 'Images only', and then uncheck 'Large images'. Right-click again and choose Left, then disable the Personal Toolbar by right-clicking on it and selecting 'Off'. Switch off the Hotlist by pressing [F4]. To

make the interface cleaner and more user-friendly, you can perform the following modifications: go to **View > Status Bar > Bottom, View > Status Bar**.



Opera is the most customisable browser around. You can easily change buttons and the position of all the toolbars

Page Bar > Top, View > Address Bar > Top, View Navigation Bar > Auto. You can drag-and-drop elements to the toolbars. We will do so for the Address Bar: right-



Illustrations: Farzana Cooper

click and choose 'Customize toolbars'. You will find three tabs here: Large, Small and Fields. The last tab is where you will find search options—the Zoom and Status fields. Let us add the Google search field to the Address Bar. Just click on it and drag it to the bar. Note that it is a drop-down field. An especially useful search criterion is 'Find' in the page search, which highlights keywords within the Web page as you type in the field.



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